

GEDYON — 12-DAY TRAINING BLOCK

Wed Sep 3 – Sun Sep 14, 2026 · Elias Gedyon · Boulder, CO (~5,300 ft) · calibrated to CURRENT fitness (165 lb, rebuild phase) — not PR fitness. Paces rise only when the green-day test says so.

YOUR PACES RIGHT NOW

ZONE	PACE	HEART RATE	FEEL / RULE
Recovery	10:30+ /mi	< 125	Shuffle. No pace floor — slower is fine.
Easy	9:30–10:15 /mi	125–140	Full sentences out loud. Most of your miles live here.
Steady	8:40–9:00 /mi	140–150	Short phrases. Used for long-run finishes.
Tempo	7:35–7:50 /mi	152–160 · CAP 162	Comfortably hard. If HR breaks the cap, slow down — hold the effort, not the number.
Strides / Hills	fast & short	spikes OK	20s strides, 80m hills. Full recovery between reps — never a grind.

The **green-day tempo test** (Fri 9/5 & Fri 9/12): on a green WHOOP day, run the 20-min tempo at 7:25–7:30. If HR stays under 165 and it feels "comfortably hard," the tempo band moves up to 7:20–7:35 for the next block. If not, nothing changes and nothing is lost.

READINESS RULES — CHECK WHOOP FIRST, EVERY MORNING

GREEN (67%+)	Run the day as written. Green quality days are where fitness is made — do not bank them.
YELLOW (34–66%)	ONE quality session max. A double's PM becomes 30 min easy. Cap tempo at HR 160. If HR won't settle in the first 8 min, convert to easy and take the session on the next green day.
RED (<34%)	No quality. Easy 30–40 min under HR 135, or full rest. The workout moves — it is never "made up" by stacking.

THE 12 DAYS

DAY	SESSION	WHAT TO DO
WED 9/3	TEMPO (single)	PM only — the missed AM is gone, don't chase it. 10–12 min easy warm-up + 2×20s strides · 20 min tempo at 7:35–7:45, HR cap 160 (yellow recovery today) · 10 min easy cool-down. ~4.5 mi total.
THU 9/4	EASY DOUBLE + CORE	AM 3 mi easy (9:30–10:15) + 6×20s strides · PM 2 mi shake-out, truly easy · Core: dead bug 3×12, plank 3×45s, Copenhagen 3×20s each side.
FRI 9/5	TEMPO — GREEN-DAY TEST	If WHOOP is green: 2 mi easy WU + 4×20s strides · 20 min at 7:25–7:30 (the test — see pace card) · 1.5 mi CD. If yellow: 20 min at 7:40–7:50 capped at 160 instead. ~6 mi.
SAT 9/6	LONG RUN	7–8 mi at 9:45–10:30, HR ceiling 145. Last 10 min may drift to steady (8:50–9:00) if feeling good. Fuel before, water on route.
SUN 9/7	ACTIVE RECOVERY	30–40 min walk/jog under HR 125 · 15 min foam roll (calves, quads, IT band) · 10 min mobility. This is where the week's work becomes fitness.
MON 9/8	EASY DOUBLE + CORE	AM 3 mi easy + 6×20s strides · PM 2 mi shake-out · Core circuit 8 min. Weigh-in this morning — trend, not the number.
TUE 9/9	THRESHOLD 1000s	2 mi easy WU + 4×20s strides · 5×1000m at 4:45–4:55/km (7:38–7:53/mi), 90s standing rest · HR ceiling 164 · 1.5 mi CD. Reps should feel repeatable — the last one no harder than the third. ~6.5 mi.
WED 9/10	HILLS + EASY	0.8 mi jog WU · 8×80m hill at max effort (8–10% grade or treadmill incline 8.0–10.0) · walk down = full recovery · 2.5 mi easy after. This is your strength session — no gym needed.

DAY	SESSION	WHAT TO DO
THU 9/11	EASY DOUBLE + CORE	AM 3 mi easy + strides · PM 2 mi shake-out · Core circuit. Nothing heroic — tomorrow matters more.
FRI 9/12	TEMPO — GREEN-DAY TEST #2	Same as 9/5: green → 20 min at 7:25–7:30; yellow → 7:40–7:50 capped. Two passed tests in one block = the whole pace card moves up next block. ~6 mi.
SAT 9/13	LONG RUN	8–9 mi at 9:45–10:30, HR ceiling 145 · last 15 min steady (8:50) if the day is green. Longest run of the block — fuel at 45 min.
SUN 9/14	ACTIVE RECOVERY	30–40 min walk/jog + foam roll + mobility. Block done — next block's paces come from what THIS block's data says.

Shaded rows = quality or long days — these are the ones the readiness rules gate. Weekly volume ~22–26 mi; if any run must be cut, cut easy miles, never the warm-up or cool-down of a quality day.

NON-NEGOTIABLES

- 1. Effort beats pace on every hard day.** The HR cap is the contract: break it, slow down. A tempo at 7:50 under the cap builds more than 7:30 over it.
- 2. Never two quality days back-to-back.** If a session moves (red/yellow day), it lands on the next green day and the following quality day slides — the block bends, it doesn't stack.
- 3. Easy means easy.** 9:30–10:15 will feel slow. That's the point — it's what lets Tuesday and Friday be real.
- 4. Weight comes off the same way pace comes back: quietly.** Fuel the quality days fully; trim on recovery days. Never run a hard session under-fueled to chase the scale.
- 5. Log every run with HR.** The app now reads pace-at-heart-rate to move your prescriptions — every logged run makes the next block smarter.